



12 PV interview questions that quietly decide the offer

These are the answers interviewers are really listening for. Swipe through before your next interview does it for you.

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Swipe →

How do you handle a case that does not meet the minimum reporting criteria?

- Start with the four criteria: an identifiable patient, an identifiable reporter, a suspect drug, and an adverse event.
- If one is missing, pursue follow up and document every attempt you make to obtain it.

What would you do if a SUSAR appears close to the submission deadline?

- Trigger an immediate medical review.
- Apply the expedited timelines (7 or 15 days).
- Escalate through the defined process.
- Always choose compliance over convenience.

How do you prioritise multiple incoming ICSRs?

- Seriousness of the case.
- Expectedness.
- Regulatory timelines.
- Country specific requirements.

Explain how signal detection is based on risk.

- Data mining.
- Disproportionality analysis.
- Clinical review.
- Benefit and risk assessment.

What happens if a regulatory reporting timeline is missed?

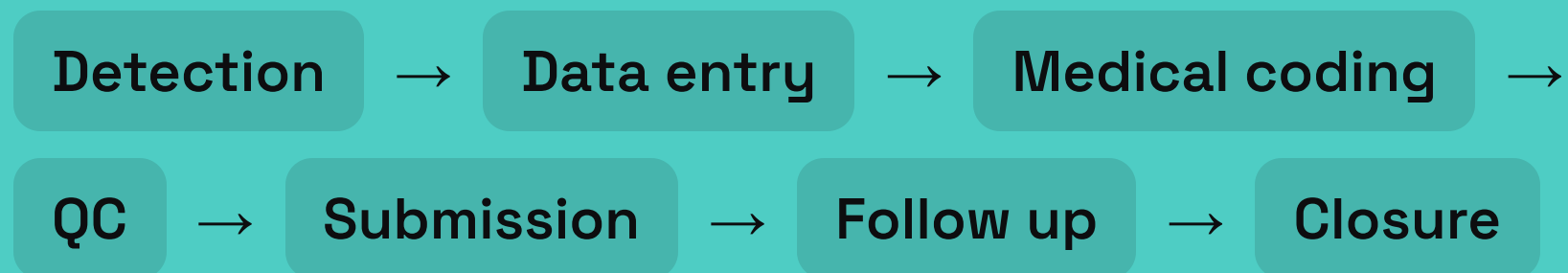
- Document the deviation immediately.
- Run a root cause analysis.
- Implement CAPA.
- Focus on preventing recurrence.

Never reduce it to “just apologise”.

How does pharmacovigilance work with Regulatory Affairs?

- Label updates.
- Aggregate reports.
- Risk management plans.
- Inspection readiness.

Explain the lifecycle of an ICSR.



What is the difference between signal validation and signal confirmation?

- Validation is the initial assessment.
- Confirmation is the deeper evaluation that drives an action decision.

How do you keep data consistent across narratives?

- Chronological clarity.
- Correct medical terminology (MedDRA).
- Logical sequencing.
- No speculation.

How do inspections affect PV operations?

- Reliable audit trails.
- SOP adherence.
- Documentation readiness.
- An inspection defence mindset.



What is the role of the QPPV?

The Qualified Person for Pharmacovigilance ensures:

- System compliance.
- Safety oversight.
- Regulatory communication.

What trends are shaping pharmacovigilance in 2026?

- Case processing powered by AI.
- Automation.
- Real world evidence.
- Rising global reporting standards.



Patient safety is not a department. It is accountability.

Strong PV interviews show four things: regulatory awareness, timeline accuracy, risk thinking, and ethical responsibility.

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